The Bag

Every state a daemon can be in, every item that ends one, and the argument for each word. **216 items are renamed**, and this page is generated from the game's own table — the shipped description is quoted, not retyped.

The rule these names follow

A name has to work twice — once as the thing in your hand and once as the thing in a computer — and if it only works once it does not ship. That test is why `PATCH` was instant and `CACHE` was refused: a patch stops a leak and patches software, while a cache needs a beat of explanation before it means anything.

The description carries a second rule, added when the state items were rewritten: **teach the term in the first clause, state the effect in the second.** *"Preemption takes control back from a process that will not yield. Ends HUNG."* The player who knows the word gets a nod; the player who does not gets a definition and never notices being taught.

The states

Vanilla leaves a creature poisoned, asleep, paralysed, burned, frozen or confused. Every one of those is a metaphor about a *body*, and this world does not have bodies — it has processes. **A state is something a process is in, and something it can be got out of.**

The three-letter code is what the party menu draws on a coloured tile, and what the battle box prints beside the name. The colours keep vanilla's hue anchors — a player who has ever seen a party menu reads orange as burning before they read the letters — and move into the muted register the type chart uses.

VANILLA	OURS	TILE	WHY IT IS THE EXACT WORD
POISON · PSN	**LEAKING**	LEK	A memory leak degrades a running process a little at a time until it dies. Nothing else in computing loses you a fixed slice per tick.
TOXIC · TOX	**CASCADING**	CAS	Badly poisoned worsens each turn, and a cascading failure is precisely a fault whose rate rises because of the damage it already did. It shares LEAKING's tile: Gen 3 has one poison slot and draws both in it.
SLEEP · SLP	**SUSPENDED**	SUS	Not gone, not scheduled, and it *resumes*. The one status that is genuinely temporary, and the word says so. The tile is slate: dormant rather than damaged.
PARALYSIS · PAR	**THROTTLED**	THR	Paralysis does two things — cuts speed, sometimes skips a turn. Throttling is a speed cap that intermittently stalls work. Both halves, one word.
BURN · BRN	**OVERHEATED**	OVR	Chip damage plus reduced output, dealt by ENTROPY, whose one-clause test is *noise and heat*. The tile is ember: heat the daemon made itself.
FREEZE · FRZ	**HUNG**	HNG	A hung process does nothing until something intervenes. **FROZEN could not be reused** — it is a type name, and the chart had just spent real effort making type names carry meaning. WATCHDOG is what ends it.

VANILLA	OURS	TILE	WHY IT IS THE EXACT WORD
CONFUSION	**THRASHING**	–	A system so busy managing itself it makes no progress and damages its own throughput. Hurting yourself in confusion is the same event. Volatile, so it needs no code.
FAINT	**HALTED**	HLT	The first of the seven, and the one that set the register for the rest: a state is something a process is *in*, and something it can be got out of.

> CASCADING shares LEAKING's tile because Gen 3 draws badly-poisoned in the same box as ordinary poison. THRASHING needs no code at all: it is volatile, so it never reaches the party screen.

The operations that end a state

Vanilla's cures are sprays and medicines. Ours are the operations you would actually perform on a process that was in that state.

VANILLA	OURS, AND WHAT THE BAG SAYS	WHY THAT WORD
ANTIDOTE	**PATCH** *A patch stops a leak at its source. Ends LEAKING, and the worse CASCADING with it.*	You patch a leak and you patch software. **The pun is the definition** — it needs no beat of confusion, which is the test CACHE was held to and failed.
AWAKENING	**RESUME** *Puts a SUSPENDED daemon back on the schedule. It was never gone, only unscheduled.*	The exact inverse of SUSPENDED, and the word an operating system uses for it.
PARLYZ HEAL	**PRIORITY** *Scheduled ahead of whatever was starving it. Ends THROTTLED.*	What lifts throttling is not medicine — it is being scheduled ahead of the thing starving you. *The weakest of the ten on the works-twice test, and kept because the mechanic is right.*
BURN HEAL	**COOLANT** *Draws off the heat a daemon made itself. Ends OVERHEATED.*	The only one of the seven that needs no domain knowledge at all. Plain, physical, and exactly right.
ICE HEAL	**WATCHDOG** *A watchdog notices a process that stopped answering, and resets it. Ends HUNG.*	**Renamed twice, and the second time was the one that mattered.** `INTERRUPT` shipped here and collided with the flute, which had taken the word six weeks earlier and keeps it. `PREEMPT` replaced it and collided with MANKEY, named four days before. *Under both collisions was a plainer fault: preempting a hung task hands the processor to somebody else and the hung one stays hung.* **A watchdog is the timer whose whole job is to notice a process has stopped answering and reset it** — the actual cure, and it still works twice.
FULL HEAL	**ROLLBACK** *Rolls back to a known-good state. Ends every state at once, whatever it was.*	Clears every state by returning to a known-good one. Says *all of it* without listing anything.

VANILLA	OURS, AND WHAT THE BAG SAYS	WHY THAT WORD
HEAL POWDER	**HOTFIX** *Bitter, cheap, and it works now. Clears every state.*	Bitter, cheap, works now, nobody is proud of it. All four are true of both meanings.
FULL RESTORE	**SNAPSHOT** *Restores a DAEMON whole: health and state together.*	Health and state together, because that is what a snapshot restores. The one cure that is a noun for a thing you saved earlier.
REVIVE	**RESTART** *Starts a HALTED daemon again with half its health. It does not remember stopping.*	The word for bringing back a halted process — and it lands on HALTED without explaining itself.
MAX REVIVE	**REBOOT** *Brings back a HALTED daemon at full health.*	Strictly bigger than a restart, which is exactly the relationship the two items have. **The ladder is free.**

The hosts

The ladder is not sizes. It is **rights** — and a box is a little machine that a daemon agrees, or does not agree, to run on.

VANILLA	OURS, AND WHAT THE BAG SAYS	WHY THAT WORD
POKé BALL	**USERBOX** *A host offered at user level. A steady daemon will run on it. A stubborn one will not.*	**A box is not a container, it is a host.** The ladder is not sizes, it is *rights* — and that is the argument: what you are doing when you bind a daemon is offering it an account on a machine.
GREAT BALL	**ADMINBOX** *A host with wider rights than a USERBOX. More daemons will agree to run on it.*	Wider rights than a USERBOX, so more daemons agree to run on it.
ULTRA BALL	**SUPERBOX** *A host with elevated rights. Most daemons will run on it, including reluctant ones.*	Elevated rights. Most daemons will run on it.
MASTER BALL	**ROOTBOX** *A host with unrestricted rights. No daemon can decline to run on it. Nothing is refused root.*	Unrestricted rights. *No daemon can decline* — which is the one place in the ladder where the metaphor turns unpleasant, and it is supposed to.
SAFARI BALL	**GUESTBOX** *A temporary host, issued at the gate and expiring at the gate. Its rights are minimal.*	Issued at the gate and expiring at the gate. A guest account is exactly a temporary host with a revocation date.

> The one-trick balls keep vanilla's shape and become one-trick boxes — `NET BOX`, `DESCEND BOX`, `NEST BOX`, `REPEAT BOX`, `TIMER BOX`, `LUXURY BOX`, `PREMIER BOX`. The ladder already carries the argument, and a second argument competing with it would blunt both.

The four inputs

Vanilla's evolution stones are four elements. Ours are four things you can give a mind, and each changes what some daemons compile to.

VANILLA	OURS, AND WHAT THE BAG SAYS	WHY THAT WORD
FIRE STONE	**AXIOM** *Something for a mind to reason from. Some daemons take a new form when given one.*	**The four inputs to a mind, not four elements.** An axiom is something to reason *from* — you do not derive it, you start there.
THUNDERSTONE	**EMBEDDING** *A representation a mind can search through. Some daemons take a new form when given one.*	A representation you can search through. The one of the four that names a technique rather than a faculty, and the only one a player may already know.
WATER STONE	**AFFECT** *Something for a mind to feel with. Some daemons take a new form when given one.*	Something to feel with. *Affect* is the clinical word, which keeps it from reading as sentiment.
LEAF STONE	**REWARD** *A signal a mind can learn from. Some daemons take a new form when given one.*	A signal to learn from. **Reward is the one of the four the whole game is arguing about** and it is never said again.

The key items

One of these is a crime scene the player carries from minute fifteen, and nothing points at it.

VANILLA	OURS, AND WHAT THE BAG SAYS	WHY THAT WORD
OAK'S PARCEL	**CC-7** *A sealed module. Part no. CC-7. Addressed to CRYSTAL CLEAR. Not to you.*	*A sealed module. Part no. CC-7.* The number goes in the item name rather than the description, so the player **carries** it for thirty hours before reading a requisition for the same part on a door.
POKé FLUTE	**INTERRUPT** *Sends an interrupt. A daemon that has stopped responding will wake.*	An interrupt is a signal that reaches something which has stopped responding. A flute that wakes a sleeping obstacle *is* that, in the plainest sense.
SILPH SCOPE	**RESOLVER** *Resolves a name that will not resolve on its own. Some things cannot be identified without it.*	Resolves a name that will not resolve on its own. DNS said as a ghost story.
FAME CHECKER	**HEARSAY** *Holds what you were told about people, and who told you. It does not check anything.*	Holds what you were *told*, and who told you. **It does not hold what is true** — the item is a citation index, and the name admits it.
TEACHY TV	**STREAM** *A stream is data read as it arrives. This one carries recorded lectures, one per MARK.*	A stream is a broadcast and a stream is a sequence you read from as it arrives. *MACHINE STREAM was measured out before taste got a vote:* the name budget is thirteen characters and that one is fourteen.
OLD AMBER	**OLD CORE** *A core recovered whole. It holds a daemon that stopped a very long time ago.*	A core recovered whole, holding a daemon that stopped a very long time ago. The museum's whole argument, carried in the bag.
HELIX FOSSIL	**HELIX CORE** *A core found at Deadstack. Wound in a spiral. Nothing has read its contents.*	Wound in a spiral. Nothing has read its contents.

VANILLA	OURS, AND WHAT THE BAG SAYS	WHY THAT WORD
DOME FOSSIL	**DRUM CORE** *A core found at Deadstack. A drum, sealed at both ends. Nothing has read its contents.*	A drum, sealed at both ends. Nothing has read its contents.

And one number

VANILLA	OURS, AND WHAT THE BAG SAYS	WHY THAT WORD
PP UP	**MP UP** *Slightly raises the maximum MP of a selected ROUTINE for one DAEMON.*	PP is *power points*, which is a body word. MP is what the rest of the genre already calls the same number, and it costs one letter.
PP MAX	**MP MAX** *Raises the MP of a selected ROUTINE to its maximum level for one DAEMON.*	Same change, same reason.

The rack

Vanilla's seventeen type boosters are seventeen unrelated trinkets — a spoon, a magnet, a lump of charcoal. Ours are seventeen labelled controls on one desk, and each one's first clause is 2.6's own test for that type. Read the rack and you have read the chart.

VANILLA	OURS, AND WHAT THE BAG SAYS	WHY THAT WORD
SILK SCARF	**CONTENT GAIN** *The thing itself, with nothing read into it. Gain lifts one channel: this one is CONTENT.*	
BLACK BELT	**LOGIC GAIN** *Rules applied step by step, not intuition. Gain lifts one channel: this one is LOGIC.*	
SHARP BEAK	**VECTOR GAIN** *A direction that never touches the ground. Gain lifts one channel: this one is VECTOR.*	
POISON BARB	**CORRUPT GAIN** *Data that has been tampered with. Gain lifts one channel: this one is CORRUPT.*	
SOFT SAND	**STRATUM GAIN** *The layer everything else runs on. Gain lifts one channel: this one is STRATUM.*	
HARD STONE	**LEGACY GAIN** *Old material everything else has had time to work on. Gain lifts one channel: this one is LEGACY.*	
SILVERPOWDER	**SWARM GAIN**	

VANILLA	OURS, AND WHAT THE BAG SAYS	WHY THAT WORD
	Many small agents; no single one matters. Gain lifts one channel: this one is SWARM.	
SPELL TAG	**LATENT GAIN** *Running below the surface, unobserved. Gain lifts one channel: this one is LATENT.*	
CHARCOAL	**ENTROPY GAIN** *Noise and heat; disorder that spreads. Gain lifts one channel: this one is ENTROPY.*	
MYSTIC WATER	**FLOW GAIN** *Everything running downhill to the lowest point. Gain lifts one channel: this one is FLOW.*	
MIRACLE SEED	**GROWTH GAIN** *Training: fitting to whatever it is fed. Gain lifts one channel: this one is GROWTH.*	
MAGNET	**SIGNAL GAIN** *Raw current, before anything interprets it. Gain lifts one channel: this one is SIGNAL.*	
TWISTEDSPOON	**CONTEXT GAIN** *The frame you read a thing in. Gain lifts one channel: this one is CONTEXT.*	
NEVERMELTICE	**FROZEN GAIN** *Locked to what it already saw. Gain lifts one channel: this one is FROZEN.*	

VANILLA	OURS, AND WHAT THE BAG SAYS	WHY THAT WORD
DRAGON FANG	**EMERGENT GAIN** *Behaviour nobody designed and nobody can account for. Gain lifts the EMERGENT channel.*	
METAL COAT	**HARDENED GAIN** *Hardened against whatever anyone tries. Gain lifts one channel: this one is HARDENED.*	
BLACKGLASSES	**OPAQUE GAIN** *The black box, from outside. Gain lifts one channel: this one is OPAQUE.*	
SEA INCENSE	**FLOW TRIM** *A trim is a small gain. This one lifts the FLOW channel a little.*	
BRIGHTPOWDER	**DITHER** *Noise added on purpose, so that nothing can be pinned exactly. Their aim slips.*	
LAX INCENSE	**DITHER TRIM** *Dither, at a lower setting. Their aim slips a little.*	
LEFTOVERS	**HEADROOM** *The margin left before anything clips. The holder recovers a little each turn.*	
CLEANSE TAG	**MUTE** *Mutes the channel wild daemons listen on. Carried in front, fewer of them approach.*	

The trap table

A berry sits there doing nothing, fires **once** when a condition is met, and is gone. That is a **handler**, and the kind installed against a machine condition is a **trap** — which is also a physical thing that catches something, so it does the double duty CHERI and PECHA never did. Which makes the pouch a TRAP TABLE, and that is the term for the array of handlers a system installs.

VANILLA	OURS, AND WHAT THE BAG SAYS	WHY THAT WORD
CHERI BERRY	**THROTTLE TRAP** *Armed against one condition and spent on it. Ends THROTTLED, once.*	
CHESTO BERRY	**SUSPEND TRAP** *Fires the moment the daemon stops being scheduled. Ends SUSPENDED, once.*	
PECHA BERRY	**LEAK TRAP** *Catches a slow loss before it compounds. Ends LEAKING, once.*	
RAWST BERRY	**HEAT TRAP** *Fires on heat the daemon made itself. Ends OVERHEATED, once.*	
ASPEAR BERRY	**HANG TRAP** *Fires when nothing else will. Ends HUNG, once.*	
PERSIM BERRY	**THRASH TRAP** *Catches a daemon making no progress against itself. Ends THRASHING, once.*	
LUM BERRY	**CATCH ALL** *The handler that takes whatever arrives. Ends any*	

VANILLA	OURS, AND WHAT THE BAG SAYS	WHY THAT WORD
	state, once.	
LEPPA BERRY	**EXHAUST TRAP** *Fires when a routine runs out of budget. Restores 10 MP, once.*	
ORAN BERRY	**LOW MARK** *The level at which something is done about it. Restores 10 HP when health falls, once.*	
SITRUS BERRY	**HIGH MARK** *The same idea, set higher and worth more. Restores 30 HP when health falls, once.*	
BERRY JUICE	**RESERVE** *Held back for the moment it is needed. Restores 20 HP.*	
FIGY BERRY	**SPICY TRAP** *Restores health, and may leave a daemon THRASHING. Which is which depends on the daemon.*	
WIKI BERRY	**DRY TRAP** *Restores health, and may leave a daemon THRASHING. Which is which depends on the daemon.*	
MAGO BERRY	**SWEET TRAP** *Restores health, and may leave a daemon THRASHING. Which is which depends on the daemon.*	
AGUAV BERRY	**BITTER TRAP** *Restores health, and may leave a daemon THRASHING. Which is which depends on the daemon.*	
IAPAPA BERRY	**SOUR TRAP**	

VANILLA	OURS, AND WHAT THE BAG SAYS	WHY THAT WORD
	Restores health, and may leave a daemon THRASHING. Which is which depends on the daemon.	
LIECHI BERRY	**AUTO ATTACK** *Turns itself up when there is little left. Raises ATTACK in a pinch.*	
GANLON BERRY	**AUTO DEFENSE** *Turns itself up when there is little left. Raises DEFENSE in a pinch.*	
SALAC BERRY	**AUTO SPEED** *Turns itself up when there is little left. Raises SPEED in a pinch.*	
PETAYA BERRY	**AUTO SP. ATK** *Turns itself up when there is little left. Raises SP. ATK in a pinch.*	
APICOT BERRY	**AUTO SP. DEF** *Turns itself up when there is little left. Raises SP. DEF in a pinch.*	
LANSAT BERRY	**AUTO CRIT** *Reaches further into the tail when there is little left. Raises the critical-hit ratio.*	
STARF BERRY	**AUTO ANY** *Turns one of them sharply up, and does not say which. Raises a random stat in a pinch.*	
BERRY POUCH	**TRAP TABLE** *Where the handlers are installed. It attaches to the POOL's pocket for important items.*	

What you do to a running daemon

1.6 named the ten items that undo a **state** and stopped there. These are the rest of the same rule: an item is an **operation**, and the question is what you would actually do to a process in that condition.

VANILLA	OURS, AND WHAT THE BAG SAYS	WHY THAT WORD
POTION	**RECOVER** *Puts back a little of what was lost. Restores 20 HP.*	
SUPER POTION	**DEEP RECOVER** *Goes further in than the first one does. Restores 50 HP.*	
HYPER POTION	**FULL RECOVER** *Everything reachable, put back. Restores 200 HP.*	
MAX POTION	**REBUILD** *From nothing, rather than from where it got to. Restores all HP.*	
ETHER	**CHARGE** *Puts the budget back for one routine. Restores 10 MP.*	
MAX ETHER	**FULL CHARGE** *One routine, all of its budget. Restores that routine's MP.*	
ELIXIR	**CHARGE ALL** *Every routine at once, a little each. Restores 10 MP to all.*	
MAX ELIXIR	**FULL RECHARGE** *Every routine, all of it. Restores the MP of every one.*	
HP UP	**MEMORY** *How much a daemon can hold before it stops. Raises*	

VANILLA	OURS, AND WHAT THE BAG SAYS	WHY THAT WORD
	base HP.	
PROTEIN	**WATTAGE** *How hard it can drive something. Raises base ATTACK.*	
IRON	**SHIELDING** *What sits between it and what is arriving. Raises base DEFENSE.*	
CARBOS	**CLOCK RATE** *How many times a second it gets to act. Raises base SPEED.*	
CALCIUM	**BANDWIDTH** *How much it can push down one channel. Raises base SP. ATK.*	
ZINC	**INSULATION** *What keeps the outside out. Raises base SP. DEF.*	
RARE CANDY	**INCREMENT** *Adds exactly one, which is what the word means. Raises the level.*	
X ATTACK	**TUNE ATTACK** *Turned up for this engagement only. Raises ATTACK in battle.*	
X DEFEND	**TUNE DEFENSE** *Turned up for this engagement only. Raises DEFENSE in battle.*	
X SPEED	**TUNE SPEED** *Turned up for this engagement only. Raises SPEED in battle.*	

VANILLA	OURS, AND WHAT THE BAG SAYS	WHY THAT WORD
X ACCURACY	**TUNE AIM** *Turned up for this engagement only. Raises accuracy in battle.*	
X SPECIAL	**TUNE SP. ATK** *Turned up for this engagement only. Raises SP. ATK in battle.*	
DIRE HIT	**TUNE CRIT** *Reaches further into the tail of the distribution. Raises the critical-hit ratio in battle.*	
GUARD SPEC.	**LOCK STATS** *Nothing outside gets to change them. Blocks stat reduction for five turns.*	
REPEL	**SUPPRESS** *Holds the channel quiet. Weak wild daemons stay away for 100 steps.*	
SUPER REPEL	**LONG SUPPRESS** *The same, held longer. 200 steps.*	
MAX REPEL	**MAX SUPPRESS** *The same, held longest. 250 steps.*	
ESCAPE ROPE	**EJECT** *Out, now, from wherever you are. Returns you to the last CHECKPOINT you used.*	
POKé DOLL	**DECOY** *Something else to attend to. Lets you DETACH from any wild daemon.*	
SUN STONE	**EXPOSURE**	

VANILLA	OURS, AND WHAT THE BAG SAYS	WHY THAT WORD
	Simply being left in front of something, for long enough. Some daemons take a new form.	
MOON STONE	**REFLECTION** *Light that came back, and the other meaning. Some daemons take a new form when given one.*	
OLD ROD	**QUERY** *Asks a body of water what is in it. The answers are shallow.*	
GOOD ROD	**DEEP QUERY** *Asks the same question further down.*	
SUPER ROD	**FULL SCAN** *Reads the whole of it rather than asking. Slow, and it finds everything.*	
ITEMFINDER	**GREP** *Finds the thing that is there and not shown. Reports a hidden item nearby.*	
TOWN MAP	**SITEMAP** *Everywhere there is, and how they join. Viewable at any time.*	
VS SEEKER	**ROLL CALL** *Asks who is listening. USERS who want to engage answer. The battery charges as you walk.*	
COIN CASE	**TOKEN CASE** *Holds the tokens the GAME CORNER deals in. It holds up to 9,999.*	

VANILLA	OURS, AND WHAT THE BAG SAYS	WHY THAT WORD
BLUE FLUTE	**WAKE TONE** *A tone that reaches something not scheduled. Ends SUSPENDED.*	
YELLOW FLUTE	**CALM TONE** *A tone steady enough to work against. Ends THRASHING.*	
RED FLUTE	**CLEAR TONE** *A tone that cuts through a binding made without asking.*	
BLACK FLUTE	**LOW TONE** *Pitched under what wild daemons answer to. Fewer appear.*	
WHITE FLUTE	**HIGH TONE** *Pitched where wild daemons answer. More appear.*	
REVIVAL HERB	**COLD START** *Brought up from nothing rather than resumed. Restarts a HALTED daemon at full health.*	
SACRED ASH	**RESTART ALL** *Every halted daemon at once, and all of them whole.*	
ENERGYPOWDER	**FIELD PATCH** *Applied where it broke, by whoever was standing there. Restores 50 HP.*	
ENERGY ROOT	**WORKAROUND** *Not the fix. The thing you do instead of the fix, and it works. Restores 200 HP.*	

The configurations

An item is an operation. A **held** item is not one — it is a setting attached to a process from outside, in force while it runs, and removable, which is exactly what an ability is not.

VANILLA	OURS, AND WHAT THE BAG SAYS	WHY THAT WORD
WHITE HERB	**REVERT** *Puts a value back the way it was. Restores a lowered stat, once.*	You revert a value to what it was. *Restores a lowered stat, once* — and the word is the operation, not a medicine.
MENTAL HERB	**UNPAIR** *Drops a binding that was formed without being asked for. Works once.*	A binding formed without being asked for is the thing the item drops. **UNPAIR is the undo of the routine that caused it**, and both are one word.
MACHO BRACE	**DEBUG BUILD** *Every step is instrumented, so it learns faster and runs slower. SPEED falls.*	**The best of the twenty-five.** A debug build is instrumented at every step, so it *learns faster and runs slower* — which is both halves of the item, in a phrase every programmer already owns.
EXP. SHARE	**WEIGHT SHARE** *Two things trained as one: what teaches the first teaches the second. Shares EXP. POINTS.*	Weight sharing is two models trained as one: what teaches the first teaches the second. *Vanilla's item is a mystery; ours is a technique.*
QUICK CLAW	**QUEUE JUMP** *Sometimes the scheduler takes you out of turn. The holder may move first.*	Priority is scheduling, and sometimes the scheduler takes you out of turn. Sits beside PRIORITY and GAUGE's whole benchmark without pointing at either.
SOOTHE BELL	**AFFINITY** *Affinity binds a process to one host. The holder grows attached faster.*	Processor affinity binds a process to one host and keeps it there. **Affinity is also plain fondness**, which is the double duty this lexicon is built on.
SMOKE BALL	**ESCAPE HATCH** *A way out that is always open. The holder can DETACH from any wild daemon.*	A way out that is always open. *It stopped being a BALL, which freed it from the guard that had been holding the name.*

VANILLA	OURS, AND WHAT THE BAG SAYS	WHY THAT WORD
EVERSTONE	**VERSION LOCK** *Pins a thing to the version it is at. The holder will not evolve.*	You pin a dependency to a version so it never moves. The holder does not evolve, and nothing about the name is a metaphor.
FOCUS BAND	**FAILSAFE** *What stops the fall when everything else already has. The holder may survive on 1 HP.*	The thing that catches you when everything else already failed. One HP is exactly what a failsafe leaves you.
LUCKY EGG	**LEARNING RATE** *How large a step each lesson takes. Turned up: the holder earns more EXP. POINTS.*	**The learning rate is how large a step each lesson takes.** Turned up, you learn faster from the same experience — which is the item, stated as the hyperparameter it is.
SCOPE LENS	**LONG TAIL** *The far end of a distribution, where the rare large values are. Raises the critical-hit ratio.*	A critical hit is the far end of the distribution. *The long tail is where the rare large values live*, and raising the crit ratio is reaching further into it.
SHELL BELL	**RECLAIM** *Takes back what is no longer in use. The holder recovers HP on striking.*	Reclaiming is taking back what is no longer in use. The holder recovers on striking, and the word is the garbage collector's.
KING'S ROCK	**BUBBLE** *A gap pushed into a pipeline where nothing issues. They may flinch.*	A pipeline bubble is a gap pushed in where nothing issues. **A flinch is a turn in which nothing issued** — and PIPELINE is a species, so the word already lives here.
CHOICE BAND	**HARD CODED** *One value, written in, with no way to pass another. Powers up one routine and allows no other.*	One value, written in, with no way to pass another. *Faster, and no longer negotiable,* which is the trade the item makes.
AMULET COIN	**SURCHARGE** *Charged on top of the agreed rate. Doubles prize money if the holder took part.*	Charged on top of the agreed rate. The one item in the set whose register is the institution's rather than the machine's.

VANILLA	OURS, AND WHAT THE BAG SAYS	WHY THAT WORD
UP-GRADE	**SERVICE PACK** *Everything that was fixed since the release, in one bundle. Made by FOUNDRY CO.*	Everything fixed since the release, in one bundle — and it is *made by SILPH CO.*, which is the joke sitting under it.
DRAGON SCALE	**SCALING LAW** *What happens to a thing when you only make it bigger. A BACKPRESS may be holding it.*	**Scaling laws are what happens to a thing when you only make it bigger**, and EMERGENT is the type this evolution item belongs to. *The argument and the mechanic said the same word.*
DEEPSEATOOTH	**DEEP FEATURE** *A representation learned far from the surface. It raises the SP. ATK stat.*	A deep feature is a representation learned far from the surface. Raises SP. ATK, and the pun keeps the sea.
DEEPSEASCALE	**DEEP LAYER** *The layers nothing outside gets at directly. It raises the SP. DEF stat.*	The layers nothing outside gets at directly. Raises SP. DEF, and pairs with DEEP FEATURE the way the two vanilla items pair.
SOUL DEW	**INNER STATE** *An orb for CASTOR or POLYDEUCES. What it holds, nothing outside can read. Raises both SP. stats.*	What a process holds that nothing outside can read. The two special stats are the mind stats, and this is the item that says so.
LIGHT BALL	**SUPPLY RAIL** *The line every other part draws from. Held by a SPIKE, it raises the SP. ATK stat.*	The supply rail is the line every other part draws from. *Held by a SPIKE*, which is what a rail carries.
LUCKY PUNCH	**FLUKE** *A result nothing predicted and nothing repeats. It raises UPTIME's critical-hit ratio.*	A result nothing predicted and nothing repeats. **Held by UPTIME**, which is the daemon whose whole name is the opposite of a fluke.
METAL POWDER	**STRICT MODE** *Refuses anything it was not promised. It raises MOCK's DEFENSE stat.*	Strict mode refuses anything it was not promised. **Held by MOCK** — and a mock object that checks its contract is exactly what the pair means.

VANILLA	OURS, AND WHAT THE BAG SAYS	WHY THAT WORD
THICK CLUB	**BARE METAL** *Nothing at all between you and the hardware. It raises ARTEFACT's and COREFILE's ATTACK.*	Bare metal is nothing at all between you and the hardware. Held by RELIC and CAIRNLING, whose register is old machinery still running.
STICK	**OFF BY ONE** *The error at the edge that everything else survives. Raises EDGECASE's critical-hit ratio.*	**An off-by-one is the error at the edge that everything else survives.** Held by EDGECASE, which is the same joke told twice and never explained.

What the budget actually is

ITEM NAME	DESCRIPTION	RENAMED SO FAR
`13 characters` *`ITEM_NAME_LENGTH` is 14 including the terminator. `MACHINE STREAM` is 14 and does not fit.*	`3 lines` *Roughly 30 characters each, measured in pixels rather than letters — the face is variable width.*	`216 items` *Derived by diffing our table against upstream's, which is the only way to tell a rename from an addition.*

Three that were harder than they look

One item was named three times, and each collision hid the next. `INTERRUPT` was assigned twice six weeks apart — to the flute, and to ICE HEAL in the state pass. The flute keeps it, because waking a thing that blocks a road is an interrupt in the plainest sense. ICE HEAL became `PREEMPT`, which collided with MANKEY, named four days earlier.

Under both collisions was a plainer fault that nobody had looked for: preempting a hung task hands the processor to somebody else and the hung one stays hung. A **watchdog** is the timer whose only job is to notice that something has stopped answering, and reset it. That is the cure, it still works twice, and it took a third reader to find — which is why the collision check now reads *every* surface out of the build rather than the ones that existed the day it was written.

`FROZEN` could not be used for the frozen state, because it is a type name and the chart had just spent real effort making type names carry meaning. `HUNG` is what the state is anyway.

The box ladder is rights, not sizes, and that is the one item family where the metaphor is allowed to turn unpleasant. A ROOTBOX has unrestricted rights and *no daemon can decline to run on it* — which is the same sentence as “it never fails”, read from the other side.

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